The previous section showed you how to add an Origin header to the curl request. The `-H` flag can also be used to add an Access-Control-Request-Method header to the request. Finally, the `-X` flag can be used to set the HTTP method. The final curl request looks like this:

```
curl --verbose -H "Origin: null" -H "Access-Control-Request-Method: GET"
     -X OPTIONS http://127.0.0.1:9999/api/posts
```

After running this command, the server will reply with the preflight response.

7.4.3 Why use curl?

There are reasons why using curl can be advantageous over making requests from a web page, including:

- Developer velocity
- Request flexibility
- Ease-of-use
- Isolation

Let's delve further into what each of these items mean.

DEVELOPER VELOCITY

Developer velocity is the speed at which you can iterate and develop your app. Tools with high developer velocity enable you to work faster.

The traditional development process for CORS is to edit code, reload the web page, and view the headers in either the developer tools or Wireshark. Curl can speed up this process because making a curl request and viewing the headers can all be done in the same window.

If you have a complicated web app, there may be additional pieces of the page that need to load, or you may need to click a button to trigger the CORS request. Another way in which curl speeds development is that it focuses solely on the HTTP request, and doesn't need to load any of those extraneous pieces.

REQUEST FLEXIBILITY

Curl is flexible enough to craft any type of HTTP request you can imagine. You can do things with curl that you can't do from a web page.

Suppose you want to test your server's behavior with requests from different origins. To do this from a browser, you'd need to upload your client code to each site that you want to test, which is cumbersome. With curl, you have the flexibility to set the Origin header (and any other header) to any value you need.

EASE-OF-USE

Curl's ease-of-use was demonstrated earlier when you learned how to trigger a preflight request from CORS. Triggering the same preflight request from JavaScript code can be a little more difficult, because you have to build the actual request, then rely on the browser to send the correct preflight. In curl, you don't need to jump through hoops to trigger a preflight.